

Article Review on Data Privacy Issue

Title of Issue: Facebook–Cambridge Analytica Data Privacy Scandal

The data privacy issue that I chose is the Facebook–Cambridge Analytica scandal that became popular in 2018. This issue happened when Cambridge Analytica collected the personal data of millions of Facebook users without proper consent. The information was used for political advertising and to influence people's opinions during elections.

In this issue, a developer created a personality quiz app on Facebook. Although only a small number of users answered the quiz, the app was also able to collect information from the users' Facebook friends because of Facebook's old privacy settings. As a result, millions of personal details such as names, interests, likes, and online activities were gathered.

The violation in this issue was the unauthorized collection and misuse of personal data. The users were not fully informed that their information would be used for political campaigns. Facebook also failed to properly protect the privacy of its users and lacked transparency about how data was being shared.

The effects of this issue were very serious. First, many people lost trust in Facebook and other social media platforms. Second, users became more concerned about online privacy and data security. Third, governments and organizations started creating stricter privacy laws and regulations. This issue showed how personal information can be used to influence public opinion and manipulate behavior.

Explanation of What Went Wrong

The main problem in this issue was the lack of proper data protection and transparency. Facebook allowed third-party applications to access a large amount of user information without strict monitoring. Because of this, personal data was easily collected and misused.

Another problem was that many users did not fully understand the privacy policies and permissions they agreed to online. Some users were unaware that their information could be shared with outside companies.

This issue could have been prevented if Facebook had stronger security measures and stricter rules for third-party apps. The company should have asked for clear user consent before collecting and sharing personal data. Regular security checks and faster responses to suspicious activities would also have helped reduce the problem.

In addition, people should be educated more about data privacy and online safety. If users are more aware, they can make better decisions when sharing personal information online.

Best Way to Protect Your Privacy

Protecting privacy online is very important today because many people use the internet and social media every day. One of the best ways to protect privacy is to avoid sharing too much personal information online.

Here are some ways to protect personal data:

- Use strong and unique passwords.
- Turn on two-factor authentication for accounts.
- Check and update privacy settings regularly.
- Avoid clicking suspicious links and messages.
- Download apps only from trusted sources.
- Be careful when using public Wi-Fi networks.
- Log out of accounts when using shared devices.

As a student, I believe that being responsible online is very important. People should always think carefully before posting or sharing personal information because not everything on the internet is safe